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Tories demand inquiry into PM's National Security chief Jonathan Powell over secret taxpayer-funded talks with 'rogue states'

TOP STARMER MANDARIN'S FIRM IS PAID FOR 'SPY OPS'

ONE of Sir Keir Starmer's most powerful advisers was last night accused of running secret diplomatic back channels to 'terrorists' using his own taxpayer-funded team of 'out-sourced spies and spooks'.

Jonathan Powell, the Prime Minister's National Security Adviser, founded the shadowy organisation after he left Tony

EXCLUSIVE

By **Glen Owen**

POLITICAL EDITOR

Blair's Downing Street, where he was chief of staff when the infamous 'dodgy dossier' helped to propel Britain into war with Iraq. The outfit, Inter Mediate, receives fund-

ing from the Foreign Office for making contact with 'non-state armed groups', and is understood to have brokered the UK's deal with Syria which led to the re-establishment of diplomatic relations earlier this month.

Mr Powell, 68, who stood down as the charity's £200,000-a-year chief executive

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Amanda:
The office
catfight
is a myth
invented
by men

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